

The Double Revolution of the 21st Century

Geopolitics and Artificial Intelligence in the Systemic Transition of Global Power.

By Javier Toret

We are living through a geopolitical and technological revolution that will shape the coming decades. Understanding this Double Revolution is vital to acting decisively in the face of what lies ahead.

Global disorder and the tectonic forces currently vying for the planet's future demand new analytical frameworks capable of capturing the uniqueness of this historical era. We are not facing disconnected political phenomena (such as Trump's visit to Beijing, the proliferation of international conflicts, or the dispute over rare earth minerals), nor mere technical advances (whether from Deepseek, Manus, or Claude), but rather a deeper structural transformation. To characterize this transformation, it is essential to analyze the historical convergence between a geopolitical revolution marked by the systemic transition toward multipolarity (represented by the rise and agency of China, the BRICS, and the Global South), and a technological-productive revolution, driven by artificial intelligence and robotics. To describe this convergence, I propose the concept of the "Double Revolution." This Double Revolution constitutes the key vector of transformation for the coming decades.

We can date the start of the Double Revolution to between 2022 and 2023, when a series of events marked a turning point and systemic acceleration. On the technological front, the launch of ChatGPT and the popularization of generative AI models—the fastest-spreading technology in history—coincided with Washington's offensive against Beijing, which restricted access to advanced semiconductors. On the geopolitical front, the war in Ukraine accelerated the fracturing of the Euro-Atlantic order. The uprisings in the Sahel culminated in the rise to power of Ibrahim Traoré, with the expulsion of French military forces. The genocide in Gaza, perpetrated by Israel with U.S. backing and European complicity, revealed the structural violence of the new imperial project of Greater Israel. Far from being isolated episodes, these milestones represent simultaneous eruptions in the tectonic plates of the world-system.

To understand the magnitude and nature of this historic moment, we can draw on the work of the Marxist historian **Eric Hobsbawm**. In his work **The Age of Revolution, 1789–1848**, Hobsbawm coined the term "Double Revolution" to conceptualize the historical process that transformed the modern world. This "Double Revolution" of the 19th century was characterized by the structural convergence of two simultaneous and intertwined revolutions: **the French Revolution**—political and ideological—and the **English Industrial Revolution**—technological and economic. Both provided the material basis (railroads, factories, the proletariat) and the superstructural basis (liberalism, nationalism, popular sovereignty) for what was, in Hobsbawm's words, "the greatest transformation of

human history since ancient times, when men invented agriculture and metallurgy, writing, the city, and the state.”

Although they emerged in different national contexts, these transformations constituted “**the twin craters of a vast regional volcano**.” Together they swept away the old feudal regime, laying the foundations for the liberal bourgeois capitalist order and consolidating the logic of colonial domination. This vast and tumultuous process generated contradictions and strong internal resistance—such as the emergence of the labor movement and socialist currents—that shaped the sociopolitical, technological, and economic conflicts and alternatives of the 19th and 20th centuries.

Just as the Double Revolution of the 19th century consolidated the Western capitalist order and its imperialist expansion—leaving the Global South as a subordinate space—two centuries later, the emergence of peripheral powers actively challenges the declining hegemon: a Global North led with an iron fist by the United States. The progressive and relative weakening of the Western geopolitical bloc entails a **conflict-ridden transition to a multipolar and polycentric world**. Geopolitical researcher Gabriel Merino considers that this process “signifies a structural and revolutionary transformation and, conversely, implies the obsolescence of the old world political order and of the institutions that crystallized the previous power hierarchies.”

The hypothesis of the Double Revolution of the 21st Century posits that we are facing **the onset of an upheaval of a magnitude comparable to that which took place between 1789 and 1848**. On the one hand, the geopolitical revolution could even lead to a third world war or the end of centuries of Western dominance over the planet. On the other hand, the revolution in AI and robotics is transforming (and will do so much more radically in the coming decade) the material foundations of science, production, labor, and the law of value.

Revolutions have a situated and uneven geography, and they often have multiple **epicenters** from which they spread through domination or contagion, generating complex phenomena of power and resistance. Hobsbawm showed how Europe was the nucleus of the dual revolution of the nineteenth century, followed by the American century, after the bipolar period of the Cold War. Today, as Giovanni Arrighi anticipated in his book *Adam Smith in Beijing**, the 21st century is witnessing “the ongoing shift of the center of global political economy from North America to East Asia.” Along these same lines, in the work *China and Global Capitalism*, Marxist theorist Lin Chun argues that this reconfiguration does not replicate imperialist logic, but rather articulates a path of sovereign development where the Chinese state seeks, with its limits and contradictions, an alternative collective trajectory within and beyond late capitalism.

At this historic crossroads, where the shift in global power and rapid technological disruption converge, two fundamental questions arise: Who will shape the forces of the technological revolution driven by artificial intelligence and robotics, how will they do so, and to what ends? Who will be the political actors of the Double Revolution of the 21st century? I will attempt to offer preliminary answers to these questions throughout this text.

The Crisis of Unipolarity and the Hyper-Imperialist Phase

The 20th century was marked by the geopolitical and technological hegemony of the United States. Following the end of World War II and the dropping of the two atomic bombs, U.S. power was consolidated during the Cold War, with the imposition of the petrodollar in the 1970s and the subsequent unipolar phase that followed the collapse of the Soviet Union. This unipolar phase was characterized by the neoliberal offensive, culminating in the global spread of the Silicon Valley technological model. On all these fronts, Washington managed to project unquestionable influence.

However, in the **21st century, this unipolar dominance is undergoing a structural crisis**, just as world-system theorists such as Immanuel Wallerstein and Giovanni Arrighi anticipated. In recent decades, Western economies have entered a phase of progressive deindustrialization and accelerated financialization, where capital is becoming detached from real production. Added to this material decline are military over-expansion, institutional crisis, and a loss of confidence in their currency and international legitimacy. More recently, as Emmanuel Todd notes in his book *The Defeat of the West*, the war in Ukraine has clearly exposed “a Western crisis, and more specifically a terminal American crisis” that threatens global stability. This perception of decline is no longer marginal: it has transcended academic circles and frequently appears in media analyses ranging from *The Economist* to *The New York Times*.

This perception of decline has accelerated the White House’s strategies to contain the rise of China, which it identifies as its systemic rival. This dynamic manifests itself in attempts to control geostrategic chokepoints; in the illegal appropriation of energy resources; and in the imposition of arbitrary sanctions on insubordinate countries, as evidenced by the six-decade-long blockade of Cuba and the siege of Venezuela, including the kidnapping of President Nicolás Maduro. It also manifests itself in the initiation of asymmetric wars, as in the case of Iran, coercive pressures, and military interventions. Gabriel Merino argues that we are facing a **“hybrid and fragmented world war,”** a multifaceted conflict where confrontation is not limited to the military sphere but includes economic, informational, and technological dimensions operating across multiple scales and scenarios. This hybrid war is the central form of conflict in the transition of global power, in the current stage of systemic chaos.

In parallel, the [Tricontinental Institute](#) for Social Research, in an exhaustive dossier, has presented another analytical framework for a geopolitical reading of the situation, coining the concept of **“hyper-imperialism.”** With this term, it defines a new stage of imperialism that emerges when hegemonic power sees its productive and financial capacity diminished, to which it responds by strengthening and concentrating military power. The dossier characterizes the Global North as a military, political, and economic bloc comprising 49 countries, including the United States, the United Kingdom, Canada, Australia, New Zealand, Israel, Japan, and other countries in Western and Eastern Europe. In the military sphere, Turkey (as a NATO member), South Korea, and the Philippines (de facto U.S. military colonies) are part of **the “U.S.-led military bloc,”** even though they are part of the Global South. This bloc accounts for 74.3% of global military spending. This strategy multiplies the risks of regional military escalations and even nuclear confrontation. Despite this, the dossier identifies a “new mood and a reawakening of the spirit to advance the unfinished projects of national liberation” in the Global South.

The Emergence of the Global South and the Multipolar Global Majority

In contrast to the Global North's militarized architecture, the Global South is not a military bloc but a diverse set of countries subordinated within the world-system that represent the majority of the world's population. It comprises 145 countries, formerly designated as the "Third World." According to the Tricontinental Institute, this group of nations lacks a commonly agreed-upon identity, although they share the fact that they are "former colonies or semi-colonies of the imperialist camp" and their "historical and contemporary marginalization in the global economic and political order." Following the Tricontinental framework, six groups of countries can be identified: independent socialist nations; those strongly pursuing sovereignty; new non-aligned nations; historically or currently progressive nations; nations heavily militarized by the U.S.; and the Diverse Global South. Beyond the heterogeneity of the Global South, the BRICS+ countries have demonstrated remarkable productive and industrial capacity that contrasts with the financialization of the West.

In 2026, the BRICS+ countries (Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, the United Arab Emirates, Indonesia, and Saudi Arabia) already account for 41% of global GDP in terms of purchasing power parity, clearly surpassing the G7's 28%. The average growth (May 2026) of the BRICS+ nations is led by India, at 6.2%, and China, at 4.4%. On average, the BRICS+ grew by 3.7% annually, more than triple that of the Western powers, which grew by 1.1%. This economic weight is compounded by **undeniable demographic clout**: the 11 BRICS+ countries are home to nearly 3.9 billion people, or between 45% and 50% of the world's population. If we consider the Global South as a whole, it accounts for approximately 85% of the world's population, compared to 15% for the Global North.

However, the **BRICS+ do not constitute a homogeneous bloc** or a cohesive ideological alliance. Rather, it is a pragmatic and economic association that brings together distinct interests, political systems, and visions of civilization, which generates **internal contradictions** and limits on its strategic coordination; as has been evident in the case of the war against Iran. Despite these heterogeneities, BRICS is moving forward, albeit slowly, in building structural autonomy and a more just international order. This commitment is manifested not only in the demand to reform the UN and expand the Security Council with permanent seats for Brazil, India, and South Africa, but above all in the construction of an alternative financial architecture. In this regard, the New Development Bank (NDB), chaired by Dilma Rousseff, is one of the most important tools for actively promoting trade in national currencies, fostering development, and advancing the BRICS+ countries toward de-dollarization, which shields their economies from unilateral sanctions.

But multipolarity is not the exclusive domain of governments. At the 2025 BRICS+ summit in Rio de Janeiro, the BRICS+ People's Council was institutionalized as a space where 120 grassroots organizations from the Global South—including the Landless Workers' Movement and the World March of Women—directly presented their demands in the context of the heads-of-state summit, which was reflected in the final declaration. This promising intersection between BRICS+ and grassroots organizations points to something deeper: that the

reconfiguration of global power requires the convergence of sovereign state projects and popular struggles to shape, from below, the direction of systemic transition. Without sovereign states, popular organizations risk being subjugated by imperial power. Without popular organization, multipolarity risks failing to overcome the inequalities of the old order. The greater the influence of movements and the greater the popular weight, the more transformative multipolarity will be.

It is at this intersection that we need the concept of **the Multipolar Global Majority** to describe a **transnational historical bloc in the making**, composed of sovereign states of the Global South, regional blocs such as BRICS+, the working classes, social movements, migrants, and critical sectors of the Global North that reject current hyperimperialism and seek to build a multipolar, sovereign, cooperative, and socially just world order. It is neither a homogeneous entity nor a purely state-based alliance, but rather a multiscalar constellation where anti-imperialist, social, feminist, ecological, anti-racist, municipalist, technological, and cultural struggles and networks converge. Its emancipatory potential depends on whether its articulation drives the transition toward multipolarity and more transformative approaches—including North-South social and economic justice, technological democratization, ecological transition, gender equity, and popular power.

The Multipolar Global Majority emerges from a long history of dispossession, coloniality, and exploitation, but also from the experience of resistance and community. It is the historical outcome—past and present—of the struggle against imperialism, capitalism, and colonialism, heir to the spirit that stretches from [Bandung](#) to the [Tricontinental](#), as theorist Vijay Prashad has shown in his works **Dark Nations** and **A People's History of the Third World**. The current primary concern of the Multipolar Global Majority is the advance of genocide and hyperimperialism, which threaten the planet with projects of old and new empires. In the digital realm, technopolitical movements defending popular digital sovereignty, open-source software, and open models face as their direct adversaries the power of the techno-oligarchs, data colonialism, and the security-driven shift toward the militarization of AI. The **Multipolar Global Majority** is the historical subject in the making of the Double Revolution of the 21st century, just as the proletariat was in the Double Revolution of the 19th century. It will be forged in bitter battles for human dignity and in the practice of a new anti-imperialist internationalism.

The Geopolitical Revolution. War and the Multipolar Triangle

The first axis of the Double Revolution is the geopolitical revolution: the systemic transition from U.S. unipolarity toward a polycentric world. **It can be defined as a process of multiple insubordination against U.S. unipolar power.** This dynamic manifests itself in a series of events: in the growth and strengthening of the capabilities of some nations in the Global South; in the Iranian resistance, its powerful effects on the Arab world, and the new status of the Strait of Hormuz; in the financial coordination of the BRICS+; in the process of de-dollarization of the global economy; in the anti-imperialist struggles in Latin America, Africa, and Asia; in the global decline in popularity, following October 7, 2023, of the

. All these events point to the struggle over the direction of the systemic transition.

Within this process, **China plays a significant role, as it is the node where the technological revolution and the geopolitical revolution converge**. Since the 1949 revolution led by Mao Zedong and Deng Xiaoping's reforms beginning in 1978, China has achieved, under the model of socialism with Chinese characteristics, the greatest reduction in poverty in human history: [800 million people](#). In just four decades, the country went from being one of the world's most impoverished nations (following the "century of humiliation") to becoming the world's second-largest economy and the leading global industrial power. At the same time, far from following a traditional expansionist logic, Beijing has remained steadfast in **its doctrine of peaceful rise and a foreign policy of non-interference**. One fact that illustrates this trajectory is that since the border conflict with Vietnam in 1979, China has neither initiated nor waged any offensive war. Its strategy has focused on South-South cooperation, articulated through the ambitious Belt and Road Initiative, a project aimed at creating connectivity corridors (ports, roads, 5G networks) with the participation of more than 150 countries.

In the face of the structural crises of the contemporary international order, Chinese President Xi Jinping formalized the vision of **"building a community with a shared future for mankind,"** implemented through a set of normative and institutional proposals: the Global Development (2021), Global Security (2022), Global Civilization (2023), and [Global Governance](#) (2025) Initiatives, complemented by the proposal on Artificial Intelligence Governance. These frameworks, grounded in the principles of the UN Charter, seek to reform and refine the global governance system by expanding the representation and voice of developing countries under five guiding principles: sovereign equality, respect for international law, multilateralism, a people-centered approach, and concrete, results-oriented action. These frameworks constitute structured proposals for a reconfiguration of the international order and a new, more equitable and inclusive governance paradigm. While they have been well received by states in the Global South, in the Global North they have gone unnoticed, if not viewed with suspicion.

The **rise of China and BRICS has become the White House's strategic obsession**, and current conflicts and wars must be understood within this framework. The protracted conflict in Ukraine, the genocide in Gaza, or the asymmetric war waged by the U.S.-Israeli axis against Iran and the Axis of Resistance are, in essence (as Brazilian geopolitical analyst Pepe Escobar argues), wars against emerging multipolarity. These are not isolated regional disputes, but wars against the Global South. They are operations aimed at fracturing the sovereign alliance between China, Russia, and Iran, seeking to prevent the consolidation of **the Eurasian multipolar triangle**. However, far from fragmenting this alliance, the attack on Iran has not only brought Iran's capabilities to the fore but has also intensified the coordination among these three nations. This strategic triangle is the key pivot of today's multipolar world, a space where the West's military, economic, technological, and ideological power cannot dominate. The increasingly comprehensive partnership between Beijing, Moscow, and Tehran constitutes, de facto, the most formidable containment bloc against U.S. hyperimperialism and the Greater Israel project.

But the geopolitical revolution is not limited to the actions of sovereign states that defy the imperial war regime; rather, it is unfolding on multiple fronts between 2022 and 2026. In the fight against the genocide of the Palestinian people; in their struggle for national liberation; in the [Freedom Flotillas](#), which demonstrate that internationalism is on the rise; in the Iranian resistance and that of the Axis of Resistance against the aggression of the “Epstein coalition.” In Africa, in the popular uprisings and [the alliance of Sahel states](#) (Niger, Mali, and Burkina Faso), which express the weariness of decades of French colonialism. Joining this wave are youth protests such as [Maandamano](#) in Kenya, the [MVIWATA](#) peasant movement in Tanzania, which links food sovereignty and the defense of the land; and the militant unionism of [NUMSA](#) in South Africa, the largest working-class union on the entire continent. In Latin America, with the struggles of indigenous and peasant movements, such as the uprisings in [Bolivia](#), the struggles in Colombia’s [Cauca](#) region, or the Brazilian [Landless Movement](#), which, alongside [Via Campesina](#), have spent years building food sovereignty and popular power. With the [strikes](#) of more than 250 million workers and peasants in India. With the [movements in Okinawa \(Japan\), Taiwan, the Philippines, South Korea, and Vietnam](#) against militarism and U.S. bases in Asia. In the Global North, with the struggles of anti-racist movements such as [Regularización Ya](#) to secure basic rights; the mobilizations against genocide such as the [wildcat general strike in Italy](#), the [disruption of the cycling race](#), or the direct actions of [Palestine Action](#); the urban movements against rent-seeking and [exorbitant rent prices](#); feminist struggles, such as the fight for recognition of care work or against [digital sexist violence](#); struggles against the authoritarian turn of societies in the Global North, such as protests against [ICE brutality](#) or the massive mobilizations against Trump by the [No Kings](#) campaign. In short, the geopolitical revolution, in this sense, is also the intensification of the class and popular struggle on a global scale. The acceleration of the multipolar geopolitical revolution depends on the strength of social struggles and their positioning within a context of war and the militarization of societies. In the Global North, movements have the opportunity to push for a break with the imperialist military axis, especially in Europe, to foster an autonomous third position that serves as a bridge to the Global South.

The technological revolution. Asymmetric AI models.

The second dimension of the Double Revolution is **the technological-productive revolution** represented by **artificial intelligence**, large-scale computing, and advances in robotics. Far from constituting an isolated advance, this process operates as a techno-economic paradigm in the sense defined by [Carlota Pérez](#): following a phase of financial and speculative establishment, it begins to reconfigure the material foundations of production, labor, and social organization. AI can be understood as the extreme maturation of the fifth technological wave—the information and telecommunications revolution—but also as the threshold of a possible sixth, post-informational wave. Advances in AI drastically shorten the iterative cycles of previous technological revolutions and drive multiple systemic effects that are still difficult to gauge. A substantial novelty compared to previous waves is the rapid pace of evolution of the current technological revolution, characterized by recursive acceleration. Artificial intelligence does not

function as just another productive sector, but rather as a general-purpose technology and cross-cutting cognitive infrastructure that empowers, intertwines, and compresses the development time of emerging fields such as quantum computing, advanced robotics, biotechnology, and genomics. For decades, the digital revolution was monopolized by the United States and exported internationally, leading to what Nick Srnicek described as [“platform capitalism.”](#) Big Tech companies have established themselves as leaders of an accumulation model in which the massive extraction of data serves as a fundamental raw material, shaping—as [Cecilia Rikap](#) warns—a new map of digital dependencies and peripheries that reproduces the asymmetries of the world-system.

The Silicon Valley model is shifting toward more aggressive forms of integration with the U.S. military. In January 2026, the [Pentagon appointed six executives from the digital sector to lead its critical technology divisions](#). At the same time, [journalistic investigations](#) claim that AI systems from Anthropic and OpenAI were used in the 2026 war in Iran, fueling the debate over Silicon Valley’s militaristic shift. But if there is one company that epitomizes [the authoritarian shift in the U.S. tech ecosystem](#), it is **Palantir Technologies**. The company founded by Peter Thiel operates as a cohesive, **cutting-edge** hub of **“techno-imperialism”** and as a strategic link between Israel and the U.S., with a presence in 19 countries, mostly NATO allies, including Spain. Palantir has operated as a death infrastructure for the Israeli military in the genocide in Gaza (as sociologist [Sergio Amadeu](#) has recounted in his book *Total War: AI and the Datafied Military-Industrial Complex*) and in the U.S. military’s actions in the war against Iran. In its recent manifesto, the company shamelessly flaunts its supremacism, disparaging other nations, presenting artificial intelligence as a “new atomic deterrent,” and calling on all of Silicon Valley to take sides in the current hyper-imperialist dynamic.

Nevertheless, the U.S. technological monopoly has been broken. As Gabriel Merino demonstrates in his inspiring article [“The BRICS and the Techno-Productive Revolution in the Transition of the World System.”](#) the BRICS countries lead both in the number of global scientific publications (China accounts for 20%) and in the production of STEM talent, where China and India hold the first and second positions and account for 20% of global R&D investment. Based on these data, Merino defines “the global geopolitical landscape as one of relative multipolarity with certain bipolar features in the technological sphere, due to the weight of the United States and China.” In this competition with bipolar features, China’s technological breakthrough has shattered any unipolar illusions. According to a report by the Australian Strategic Policy Institute ([ASPI](#)), while the U.S. led in 60 out of 64 critical technologies between 2003 and 2007, in the 2019–2023 period China has come to lead in 57 of the 64 categories analyzed. According to researcher [Jeff Xiong](#), China “achieved relative independence in digital sovereignty five years ago.” Regarding the growth of the BRICS countries’ techno-scientific capabilities, Xiong asserts that “we face structural difficulties in the process of achieving digital sovereignty. “The first challenge is the high dependence on digital infrastructure provided by the United States.” For this reason, he identifies digital sovereignty as a key arena for the Global South in the coming decades. Xiong suggests that “Chinese companies and countries in the **Global** South must co-construct a new digital infrastructure and also develop and explore governmental methodologies that combine Chinese experience with local realities.”

To understand the nature of this battle, it is key to revisit the Marxist concept of General Intellect. In the *Grundrisse*, Marx anticipated that the system of machines and accumulated social knowledge would, upon surpassing a critical threshold, become a direct productive force. In the era of large-scale computing, artificial intelligence, and the advance of automation, the **General Intellect** could be renamed **Computational Intellect**. It is composed of accumulated social knowledge materialized in systems of artificial intelligence machines, data, networks, algorithms, digital infrastructures, techno-scientific labor, and social cooperation distributed under the Marxian figure of the collective worker. Therefore, AI expresses the historical materialization of centuries of cognitive labor, collective data, the struggle against automation, and popular knowledge processed and standardized algorithmically.

Computational Intellect is the subject of technopolitical dispute: under a techno-imperial logic, it aligns with private accumulation, war, and algorithmic control, but under a logic of social reappropriation, it can become a resource for communities in struggle, a source for the development of new productive forces, an aid in the rational management of the commons, or a starting point for the reduction of working time. **It is not a matter of rejecting AI or robotics; it is a matter of contesting their purposes, their production, and their governance.**

Researcher Paola Ricaurte, drawing on decolonial feminism, demonstrates in practice, through the [Feminist AI](#) project, how this **appropriation of AI for transformative purposes** takes shape. Part of her academic work has focused on highlighting how artificial intelligence reproduces coloniality, patriarchy, racism, and digital extractivism. However, in an [interview](#) about the possibility of a Feminist AI, Ricaurte stated that this must be conceived from a Marxist perspective, as if it were a matter of seizing the means of production: “if we are the ones who can obtain, take, design, think, and create the tools on our own terms, with values other than those of capitalism.” The struggle over who creates and applies artificial intelligence—and how—concerns not only states and large corporations but also the social appropriation of AI by communities, social organizations, and movements.

The strategic divergence between the artificial intelligence models of the United States and China goes beyond the classic question of who is winning the race. It reflects different logics, strategies, and goals. Broadly speaking, while the U.S. ecosystem is made up of closed architectures, focuses on pure innovation, fuels a business model based on financialization, and drives military-industrial integration and hype, China has opted for a different vision. Under the principle of cyber sovereignty, the Asian country integrates AI into real-world production chains, such as manufacturing and logistics; emphasizes practical application across more sectors, such as healthcare or education; and deploys models that are predominantly open-source and open-weight. This divergent strategy **responds to different logics of accumulation and governance**. The U.S. seeks to consolidate a monopoly on increasingly militarized algorithmic power and be the first to achieve what Sam Altman, CEO of OpenAI, himself considers the most valuable commodity in history: [AGI](#) (artificial general intelligence).

China, for its part, aims to strengthen technological self-sufficiency and deploys open ecosystems geared toward efficiency and reducing the per-token cost of AI models, which provides countries in the Global South with alternatives for implementing and using free or more affordable AI systems. As theorist [Yu Hong](#) argues, unlike the Western model of corporate deregulation, the Chinese state, in conjunction with market forces and class interests, is actively building and realigning its digital sector. In this vein, as Hong explains, in contrast to the Silicon Valley model (where the state operates as a client and enabler of private monopolies), platformization in China is strictly subordinated to state planning, national security, and the political objectives of sovereign industrial development, preventing corporate rationality and power from dominating political power. However, this should not lead us to uncritically glorify the Chinese technological ecosystem, since, as Hong and researcher Kate Crawford point out, it generates similar dynamics of job insecurity and the extractive nature of platform capitalism.

But the battle over Computational Intelligence is not being waged exclusively between different AI models, nor merely between Big Tech and states defending their digital sovereignty. It also plays out in other dynamics, such as the appropriation of AI by grassroots movements, the fight against the rampant extraction of planetary resources—as Crawford has shown in his book *Atlas of AI*—and the organization of low-, medium-, and highly-skilled cognitive workers. This is a new computational cognitive working class, ranging from [AI labelers](#) and [moderators in Kenya](#), to [call center and BPO workers in the Philippines](#), to [Google DeepMind researchers](#) who are unionizing against the military use of AI. In popular movements across the Global South, the social reappropriation of AI is a growing trend. Recently, in May 2026, Brazil's Landless Workers' Movement (MST) launched [IARAA](#), its own artificial intelligence trained to assist in agroecology and popular agrarian reform, demonstrating that technology can be subordinated to the needs of the rural working class. Following a similar logic, [the Feminist AI Network in Latin America and the Caribbean](#), and projects such as [Data Against Femicide](#), [Common Land](#), or transhackfeminist networks like [Código No Binario](#) politicize algorithms to combat patriarchal violence and data colonialism. In India, [the free software movement](#) is fighting the implementation of mandatory biometric control and, years ago, defeated Meta in its plan to capture the internet of the world's most populous country, while neighborhood assemblies, from [Chile](#) to [Uruguay](#), are succeeding in halting the installation of extractivist megaprojects for data centers.

Simultaneously, in the Global North, technopolitical campaigns such as [Tech For Palestine](#) have emerged in recent years; Amazon and Google workers organized strikes under the [No Tech for Apartheid](#) campaign, denouncing collaboration with the [Nimbus](#) project, and protests and initiatives against Palantir—such as the [Purge Palantir](#) campaign—have multiplied, along with actions against the militarization of AI and its authoritarian and surveillance uses. In terms of building technological alternatives, we can highlight projects such as [Mastodon](#) and Signal, the [Fediverse](#) ecosystem, or the participatory and collective intelligence platform [Decidim](#) (community-based and open-source), which has become an international benchmark for participatory democracy processes.

These projects and movements, though still fragmented, show that the intersection between them—in terms of labor rights, environmental justice, and the development of alternatives—is

a cornerstone to ensure that the technological revolution is not captured by techno-imperialism, nor managed exclusively by a handful of technoligarchs.

The Double Revolution as a strategic compass.

The Double Revolution is an analysis of our times that aims to serve as a strategic compass to guide us in the coming decades. It aspires to function as a coordinate map for interpreting the central historical trends in the world-system: the convergence between the technological revolution of artificial intelligence and the geopolitical revolution of the transition of global power. **Both diverge in an antagonistic manner.** On one side stands U.S. hyperimperialism, a declining power that militarizes geopolitics and artificial intelligence. On the opposite side stands the Multipolar Global Majority (states, regional blocs, and popular movements of the Global South, alongside critical defectors from the Global North), which resists attacks and aggression, designs alternative financial architectures, and builds technological sovereignties and open models to break digital dependency. Recognizing this antagonism, we must ask ourselves looking toward the future: will this Double Revolution be dominated by techno-imperialism, or will it be led by multipolar powers? And, beyond that, will popular forces be the protagonists of a radical transformation of capitalist power relations? The outcome of the Double Revolution is uncertain; it will depend on the balance of power among the various geopolitical actors, on the ability to link struggles with new emancipatory projects, and on who controls—and how—the technological revolution of Computational Intellect.

Hobsbawm showed how the Double Revolution of the 19th century created **new social classes and new political subjects**. But who will be the political subjects of the 21st-century Double Revolution? This question demands an honest answer: they are not yet fully formed, but, even if only in an incipient and isolated way, many of their components are already on the table. The global left suffers from both hyper-fragmentation and a lack of international strategic coordination, a disconnect from its highly precarious social base following years of neoliberal hegemony, and even a lack of understanding of the scope of the technological revolution. Thematic, geographic, and ideological fragmentation confines struggles to partial and disconnected agendas. Despite this, the recomposition of a transnational historical bloc capable of meeting the challenge of the Double Revolution—embodied in the Multipolar Global Majority—is already underway. This recomposition will not come through ideological, identity-based, or religious uniformity, but through the construction of unifying banners that articulate diversity. To this end, it is key to reimagine massive spaces for protest and international coordination based on the experience of previous political cycles, adapting them to the current conditions described.

Strategic unity is built around these elements and in the face of the principal enemies that this historical phase imposes. The internationalist activist Tiago Ávila sums it up clearly and simply: “We have to defeat Netanyahu and Trump. We have to overthrow the war criminals. We need to defeat the military-industrial complex that profits from war. The big tech companies that want to control our lives. We need to build a different future.” This call could translate into a future

where the class struggle and the struggle of the peoples, the fight against North-South hierarchies, anti-imperialism, digital sovereignty, and AI sovereignty merge with the defense of life and the planet, in a single emancipatory project that is decisive in the systemic transition. An enormous challenge for the coming decades. It is not enough to announce the collapse of the old Western world, nor is it even enough to imagine the end of capitalism. It is a matter of pushing forward and radicalizing the new multipolar world that is already underway, so that the Double Revolution of the 21st century unfolds with all its emancipatory force.

Barcelona. May 15, 2026